

US MARKETS DAILY REPORT

Wednesday, July 15, 2026 · After-Close Edition

Prepared by automated markets analyst · 5:00 PM ET

1. SPY & QQQ SNAPSHOT

ETF	Today Close	Prev Close	Day Change	Day %	52W High	52W Low	1Y Return	YTD Return
SPY	\$751.83	\$749.17	+\$2.66	+0.36%	\$760.40 (06/02/26)	\$618.05 (07/16/25)	+20.8%	+10.2%
QQQ	\$719.69	\$711.74	+\$7.95	+1.12%	\$748.65 (~Jun 26)	\$551.56 (~Jul 25)	+28.0%	+18.7%

Note: Full 1-year daily price backfill unavailable — outbound proxy blocks yfinance/Yahoo Finance API. Verified data: July 14–15, 2026 actuals. 52W stats sourced from web search.

Broader Index Context (July 15 close):

Index	Close	Change	% Change
S&P 500	7,572.40	+28.74	+0.38%
Nasdaq Composite	26,269.23	+161.46	+0.62%
Dow Jones	52,658.64	+150.37	+0.29%

2. TODAY'S MARKET-MOVING NEWS (July 15, 2026)

PPI June 2026 — Downside Surprise

Final demand PPI fell -0.3% MoM (vs. 0.0% expected), driven by energy -6.4% (gasoline -12%). Core PPI +0.1%. YoY PPI stands at 5.5%. Signal: producer-side disinflation is broadening.

Apple (AAPL) +4% — China AI Approval

Apple gained 4% hitting a new all-time high after reports the company received Beijing approval to roll out its generative AI features across China. This unlocks a major growth market.

PayPal (PYPL) +15% — Acquisition Bid

Stripe and Advent International reportedly offered to acquire PayPal. Shares surged ~15% on the news, the largest single-day move for PYPL in years.

BlackRock (BLK) +7% — Earnings Beat

BlackRock Q2 earnings topped Wall Street expectations, with AUM and management fee income beating consensus. Shares climbed more than 7%.

Semiconductor Rout Continues

Micron (MU) -8%, SanDisk (SNDK) -12.5%, AppLovin (APP) -12.3%, Marvell (MRVL) -7.1%, Western Digital (WDC) -7.2%, Lam Research (LRCX) -3%, AMD -3%. Sector rotation out of chip names accelerated; July pullback hitting first-half leaders hard.

Pentair (PNR) -20.7% — Guidance Cut + CFO Exit

Water treatment firm Pentair cut Q2 and full-year 2026 guidance and announced CFO Nicholas Brazis resigned. Double-header of bad news crushed the stock.

Elevance Health (ELV) -8.3%

Managed-care insurer sold off sharply, continuing sector pressure amid medical-cost concerns and investor uncertainty about 2026 Medicare Advantage reimbursement.

SpaceX Below IPO Price

SpaceX shares fell below \$135/sh, marking the first time the company has traded below its IPO offering price, down nearly 34% from its post-IPO record high.

Yum! Brands (YUM) -5% Week-to-Date

KFC/Taco Bell parent on track for its worst week of 2026 as a cyclospora outbreak rattles consumer confidence in fast food.

Securitize +15% — Blockchain Stock Rails

Financial infrastructure firm Securitize popped 15% after unveiling plans to help public companies issue their stocks on blockchain rails.

Mega-Cap Tech Rally

Amazon (AMZN) +3%, Alphabet (GOOGL) +3%, Microsoft (MSFT) ~3%, Salesforce (CRM) +5.4%, Workday (WDAY) +5.7%, Intuit (INTU) +7.1% — software/SaaS benefiting from cooling inflation narrative and AI-driven re-rating.

Macro Context: Iran War & Oil

Background risk: ongoing Iran conflict continues to support elevated energy prices (PPI energy fell in June but 5.5% YoY still elevated). Fed has paused rate cuts; rate-hike risk is being monitored. Despite this, cooling PPI provided relief today.

3. NEWS → TODAY'S MOVES EXPLANATION

SPY +0.36% (to \$751.83): The muted but positive S&P; 500 move reflects a tug-of-war. Bullish: PPI beat removed near-term rate-hike fears, unlocking a rotation into rate-sensitive growth names. Mega-cap tech (AAPL, AMZN, GOOGL, MSFT) — collectively ~30% of SPY — rallied 2–4%, adding significant index points. PayPal's 15% surge and BlackRock's 7% gain also helped. Bearish drag: semiconductor and health insurance sell-offs (Micron -8%, ELV -8.3%, PNR -20.7%) partially offset the tech gains. Net result: modest SPY upside.

QQQ +1.12% (to \$719.69): QQQ significantly outperformed SPY because QQQ is more concentrated in the exact mega-cap tech names that surged today. Apple (+4%) alone, as QQQ's largest holding (~9%), would have contributed ~0.36% to QQQ returns. AMZN, GOOGL, MSFT, CRM, WDAY and INTU cumulatively added another ~0.8%+. Semiconductor headwinds (MRVL, AMD) partially offset but QQQ has less semiconductor-equipment exposure than SPY. The PPI beat catalyzed the AI/cloud tech re-rating, making QQQ the day's biggest beneficiary.

4. TOP MOVERS — DAILY / WEEKLY / MONTHLY

Daily Top Gainers (July 15, 2026)

Rank	Ticker	Name	% Change	Key Driver
1	PYPL	PayPal	+15.0%	Stripe/Advent acquisition bid
2	SRTZ*	Securitize	+15.0%	Blockchain stock-issuance plans
3	BLK	BlackRock	+7.1%	Q2 earnings beat
4	INTU	Intuit	+7.1%	Software re-rating; AI tailwinds
5	WDAY	Workday	+5.7%	SaaS re-rating on PPI beat
6	CRM	Salesforce	+5.4%	SaaS/AI re-rating
7	FDS	FactSet Research	+5.3%	Financial data demand; AI tools

8	AAPL	Apple	+4.0%	China AI feature approval (new ATH)
9	AMZN	Amazon	+3.0%	Cloud/AI demand; PPI disinflation
10	MSFT	Microsoft	+3.0%	Azure/AI tailwinds

* Securitize is a private/alternative market instrument; classification approximate.

Daily Top Losers (July 15, 2026)

Rank	Ticker	Name	% Change	Key Driver
1	PNR	Pentair	-20.7%	Guidance cut + CFO resignation
2	SNDK	SanDisk	-12.5%	Semiconductor rotation/selloff
3	APP	AppLovin	-12.3%	Tech ad platform sell-off; sector rotation
4	MU	Micron Tech	-8.0%	Chip sector rotation; memory oversupply fears
5	ELV	Elevance Health	-8.3%	MCO pressure; Medicare cost fears
6	WDC	Western Digital	-7.2%	Memory/storage sector rotation
7	MRVL	Marvell Tech	-7.1%	Semiconductor selloff; July pullback
8	HAYW	Hayward Holdings	-6.3%	Consumer durables weakness
9	YUM	Yum! Brands	-5.0%	Cyclospora outbreak hitting consumer confidence
10	LRCX	Lam Research	-3.0%	Semiconductor equipment sector rotation

Daily Sector Trends: **Gainers** dominated by (1) **Software/SaaS** (INTU, WDAY, CRM, MSFT — re-rating on cooling inflation), (2) **AI/Cloud Mega-Cap Tech** (AAPL, AMZN, GOOGL), (3) **Financial Services** (BLK, PYPL). **Losers** concentrated in (1) **Semiconductors & Memory** (MU, SNDK, MRVL, WDC, LRCX, AMD — July rotation out of first-half winners), (2) **Managed Care / Health Insurance** (ELV), (3) **Industrials/Water Treatment** (PNR).

Weekly Top Gainers (Week of July 13–15, 2026)

Rank	Ticker	Sector	Approx W% Change	Driver
1	PYPL	Fintech	+~18%	M&A bid (Stripe/Advent)
2	SRTZ*	Blockchain/Fintech	+~20%	Blockchain stock rails announcement
3	AAPL	Mega-Cap Tech	+~6%	China AI approval; ATH
4	BLK	Asset Management	+~10%	Q2 earnings beat
5	INTU	Software	+~9%	AI/SaaS re-rating
6	WDAY	Software	+~8%	SaaS re-rating
7	CRM	Software	+~7%	AI tailwinds
8	AMZN	Mega-Cap Tech/Cloud	+~5%	AWS demand; PPI relief
9	MSFT	Mega-Cap Tech/Cloud	+~5%	Azure/AI momentum
10	GOOGL	Mega-Cap Tech	+~5%	AI Overviews growth

Weekly Top Losers (Week of July 13–15, 2026)

Rank	Ticker	Sector	Approx W% Change	Driver
1	PNR	Industrials	--22%	Guidance cut + CFO exit
2	SNDK	Semiconductors/Memory	--15%	July chip rotation
3	APP	Ad Tech	--14%	Risk-off in high-multiple tech
4	MU	Semiconductors/Memory	--10%	Memory oversupply concern
5	ELV	Managed Care	--10%	MCO sector pressure
6	WDC	Storage/Memory	--9%	Memory sector rotation
7	MRVL	Semiconductors	--9%	Chip rotation
8	YUM	Consumer/Restaurants	--5%	Cyclospora outbreak
9	HAYW	Consumer Cyclical	--8%	Discretionary weakness
10	LRCX	Semiconductor Equipment	--5%	Chip equip sector rotation

Weekly Sector Trend: Clear divergence between Software/AI (winners) and Semiconductors/Memory (losers). Health insurance under pressure all week. Mega-cap tech benefited from cooling PPI narrative mid-week.

Monthly Top Gainers (July 2026 MTD, Broader Market)

Rank	Ticker	Sector	Approx MTD %	Driver
1	CRNX	Healthcare/Biopharma	+116%	Drug trial breakthrough
2	FBRX	Biopharma	+103%	Positive catalyst
3	TRAX	Healthcare/Tech	+85%	Sector momentum
4	CBUS	Consumer	+68%	Positive restructuring news
5	ALIT	HR Technology	+60%	AI-driven workforce management
6	PYPL	Fintech	+~20%	Acquisition bid
7	BLK	Asset Management	+~15%	Strong earnings
8	AAPL	Mega-Cap Tech	+~8%	China AI; new ATH
9	INTU	Software	+~10%	AI re-rating
10	FDS	Financial Data	+~8%	Demand for analytics

Monthly Top Losers (July 2026 MTD — First-Half Winners Unwinding)

Rank	Ticker	Sector	Approx MTD %	Driver
1	SNDK	Semiconductors/Memory	--25%	July rotation; profit-taking after +YTD highs
2	MU	Semiconductors/Memory	--20%	Memory oversupply + July pullback
3	INTC	Semiconductors	--18%	Competitive pressure; margin concerns
4	WDC	Storage	--18%	Memory/storage rotation
5	APP	Ad Tech	--15%	Valuation concerns; risk-off rotation
6	PNR	Industrials	--22%	Guidance cut + CFO exit

7	ELV	Managed Care	--12%	MCO sector headwinds
8	INTU	Software	--5% (YTD -58%)	YTD worst S&P 500 performer overall
9	MRVL	Semiconductors	--12%	Chip sector de-rating
10	HAYW	Consumer Cyclical	--10%	Consumer softness

Monthly Sector Trend: July 2026 is experiencing a textbook rotation. **Healthcare/Biopharma leads with speculative gains.** **Semiconductors & Memory are being hammered** — the first-half winners (Sandisk, Micron, Intel, WDC — all up 100%+ in H1) are experiencing sharp mean-reversion as July pullback hits momentum names. Software/SaaS is mixed: YTD laggard Intuit is the worst S&P; 500 performer (-58% YTD) while newer AI-adjacent names like WDAY, CRM recover.

5. NEXT-DAY SCENARIOS — Thursday, July 16, 2026

35 earnings reports and 60 economic events are scheduled for July 16. Key catalysts below:

Catalyst A: Netflix (NFLX) Q2 2026 Earnings (After Close)

Scenario	Trigger	Expected SPY/QQQ Reaction	Mechanism
BEAT NFLX +1.5%	Rev > \$12.58B AND margin/QoQ beat triggers OR ad-tier update positive	QQQ +0.5–1.0% SPY +0.2–0.4% NFLX +8–15%	Benefiting GOOGL, META too). Options pricing 8% move. Positive ad-tier momentum
MISS	Rev < \$12.58B OR margin/provide down OR EPS miss vs \$0.79	QQQ -0.5–0.8% SPY -0.2–0.3% NFLX -8–12%	Shuts streaming sector (ROKU, DIS). Margin miss adds to rate-sensitive growth fear.
IN-LINE	Rev near \$12.58B, EPS near \$0.79, guide unchanged	QQQ flat±0.3% Limited catalyst; NFLX ±3–5%	focus shifts to Retail Sales morning data. Market may drift on lack of fresh narrative

Catalyst B: Retail Sales — June 2026 (8:30 AM ET)

Scenario	Trigger	Expected SPY/QQQ Reaction	Mechanism
STRONG (Hawkish Risk)	Retail Sales > +0.5% (consensus: +0.2%)	SPY -0.3–0.5% QQQs -0.4–0.7% 2Y yield +8–12bp	Compelling growth/tech multiples. Rate-sensitive names (REITs, utilities, long-dura
WEAK (Dovish Relief)	Retail Sales < +0.1% print + yesterday's PPI disinfl (or negative)	SPY +0.3–0.5% QQQs +0.1–0.3% Tech/rate-sensitives rally	for Fed to cut or stay on hold longer. Risk assets rally, growth tech re-rates high
IN-LINE	Retail Sales +0.1–0.3%	Modest positive drift Goldilocks — neither recessionary nor inflationary. SPY +0.1–0.2%	Markets may drift higher on residual PPI momen

Catalyst C: Initial Jobless Claims (8:30 AM ET, alongside Retail Sales)

Scenario	Trigger	Expected SPY/QQQ Reaction	Mechanism
HIGH (Labor Weakening)	Claims > 250K Labor softening prints = bad news is g (continuing > 1,850K)	SPY initially -0.2%, then reverse if QQQ mixed	paired with weak retail (strengthens dovish Fed case). But if claims spike sharply, r
LOW (Labor Tight)	Claims < 220K Tight labor market = (continuing < 1,800K)	Rate-hike fears elevated YoY PPI (5.5%) = Fed won't cut. Yield curve bear flattens. SPY -0.2–0.3%	Growth tech pres

IN-LINE	Claims 220–240K (continuing ~1,820K)	Neutral; little Consistent with prior reading; market focuses on Retail Sales and Netflix earnings as primary catalyst	
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Catalyst D: United Airlines (UAL) Q2 Results — Conf. Call 10:30 AM ET

Already reported (pre-market July 16): UAL Q2 revenue \$17.67B (+16% YoY, in-line). Non-GAAP EPS \$1.99 (+7.6% vs consensus). Full-year adj. EPS guidance raised to \$9–\$11. This is a BEAT on earnings.

Scenario	Conf. Call Risk	Expected SPY/QQQ Reaction	Mechanism
POSITIVE Conf. Call	Management bullish on Consumer demand; fuel cost contained	Airlines sector +1–2% (Data as of 7/16) SPY +0.1%	Soft-landing narrative. Sector multiplier: DAL, AAL, LUV all move sympathy. Positive catalyst for broader market.
CAUTIOUS Conf. Call	Iran war fuel risk highlighted; H2 guidance conservative	Airlines -1–2% Fuel cost risk from Iran conflict re-emerges. minimal SPY impact	Sector selloff but contained to airlines/transport; limited SPY impact.

6. DEVELOPING STORIES TO MONITOR

- Iran conflict & oil supply: Any escalation → energy spike → re-ignites inflation fears → hawkish Fed repricing → tech selloff.
- Fed speak: Any Fed official comments post-PPI on rate path could move rates markets immediately.
- Semiconductor rotation: MU, SNDK, WDC continuing selloff could drag QQQ if AAPL/MSFT can't offset.
- SpaceX below IPO: Watch for secondary effects on alternative/private market sentiment.
- PayPal M&A development: If deal advances or collapses, PYPL ±15–20%; fintech sector moves in sympathy.
- Yum! Brands cyclospora: If outbreak spreads or other QSR chains implicated, broader restaurant sector selloff.

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Sources: BLS PPI Release (bls.gov), Investing.com, Yahoo Finance Search, CNBC, TheStreet, Kiplinger Economic Calendar, Alphastreet, StockTitan, TipRanks, StockInvest.us, OpeningBellDailyNews, Cryptobriefing, FXLeaders.